



HNDIT4242-Computer Services Management



Lecture 07

Customer Liaison (Simulation of a Customer Liaison Scenario)



Lesson Objectives

- Identify **key challenges** in customer liaison and support.
- Develop **effective communication skills** for IT customer service.
- Handle **customer complaints** professionally using structured approaches.
- Conduct a **simulation exercise** to practice IT customer service scenarios.
- Understand the **importance of customer satisfaction and feedback mechanisms**.



1. Understanding Customer Needs in IT Support

1.1 Importance of Effective Communication in IT Services

- IT professionals must **translate technical issues** into simple terms for customers.
- Use **active listening** techniques to fully understand the customer's problem.
- Maintain a **polite and professional tone**, even when dealing with difficult customers.

Best Practices:

- ✓ Listen carefully and acknowledge concerns.
- ✓ Ask clarifying questions to understand the issue.
- ✓ Provide clear and concise responses.
- ✓ Follow up to ensure the problem is resolved.



1.2 Identifying Customer Expectations

Customers expect:

- **Quick response times** – Delays can lead to dissatisfaction.
- **Accurate information** – Misinformation damages trust.
- **Empathy and understanding** – Customers want to feel heard and valued.
- **Efficient problem resolution** – Issues should be resolved in a timely manner.



1.3 Common Customer Liaison Challenges in IT

- **Technical language barrier** – Customers may not understand IT jargon.
- **Handling frustrated customers** – IT failures can cause stress for users.
- **Slow response times** – A lack of urgency can lead to customer dissatisfaction.
- **Unresolved issues** – Poor problem management affects customer confidence.



2. Simulation of a Customer Liaison Scenario

2.1 Handling Customer Complaints Professionally

A structured approach is essential for handling complaints effectively.

The 5-Step Approach to Handling Complaints:

- **Acknowledge** – “I understand this issue must be frustrating for you.”
- **Apologize (if necessary)** – “I’m sorry for the inconvenience caused.”
- **Investigate** – “Let me check what went wrong and find a solution.”
- **Provide a Solution** – “I can resolve this by...”
- **Follow Up** – “I will ensure this issue does not happen again.”



2.2 Role-Playing: Customer Liaison Simulation

Students will act out customer service scenarios in pairs or small groups.

Scenario Examples:

- **Password Reset Issue:**
 - » A customer is locked out of their account and needs urgent access.
 - » The IT support agent must guide them through the reset process.
- **Slow Internet Connection in an Office:**
 - » A company employee complains about **slow Wi-Fi speeds**.
 - » The IT support agent troubleshoots the issue and provides solutions.
- **Software Installation Failure:**
 - » A customer tries to install **Microsoft Office** but encounters an error.
 - » The IT support agent assists with troubleshooting.
- **Data Breach Alert:**
 - » A customer is concerned about **unauthorized access** to their email.
 - » The IT agent explains security measures and advises on next steps.



2.2 Role-Playing: Customer Liaison Simulation

Each scenario should focus on:

- » How to greet and communicate with the customer.
- » Steps to identify and analyze the issue.
- » Providing clear and professional solutions.
- » Following up to ensure resolution.



2.3 Using a Structured Approach to Solve Customer Issues

Organizations follow structured frameworks for customer service, such as:

1. ITIL Service Management

- **Incident Management** – Resolving **urgent technical issues**.
- **Problem Management** – Identifying the **root cause** of repeated complaints.

2. Customer Support Ticketing Systems

- Examples: **Jira, ServiceNow, Freshdesk**.
- Used to track and resolve customer issues systematically.



Summary

- **Customer liaison** is a critical skill in IT service management.
- **Effective communication** improves customer satisfaction and trust.
- **Handling complaints professionally** requires a structured approach.
- **Simulation exercises** help students practice real-world IT support scenarios.
- **Customer feedback** is essential for improving IT services.



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